

Women's Suffrage and the 19th Amendment

Weigh what changed, what changed slowly, and what stayed the same across the long fight for women's suffrage — and judge whether the 19th Amendment was a true turning point.

? Historical challenge

In 1920, the 19th Amendment declared that the right to vote could not be denied 'on account of sex.' But the amendment capped a 70-year struggle — and it did not give every woman the vote in practice. Compare before, during, and after, then judge: was the 19th Amendment a genuine turning point in American democracy, or a partial victory that left major exclusions in place?

1 Investigate

SOURCES 1

19th Amendment to the U.S. Constitution (1920) – National Archives

PRIMARY SOURCE

The amendment barring denial of the vote 'on account of sex.'

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What exactly does the amendment say?
- What does it not address?

SOURCES 2

Overview of the Nineteenth Amendment – Constitution Annotated (Library of Congress)

SECONDARY SOURCE

The amendment's text and legal grounding.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- How is the amendment's power described legally?
- What questions does it leave open?

SOURCES 3

African American Women and the Nineteenth Amendment – National Park Service

SECONDARY SOURCE

How Black women were often blocked from voting after 1920.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- Who was still barred from voting after 1920?
- When did that begin to change?

2 Build your Event Map

Fill in the organizer from the evidence. Mark information with ①②③ to show which source it came from. Leave a space blank if the sources don't tell you.

THE EVENT		
Women's Suffrage and the 19th Amendment		
1848–1920		
The United States		
Before	During	After
Changed significantly	Changed gradually	Stayed mostly the same
Was this event truly a turning point? Use evidence from at least two sources.		

Sources 1Sources 2Sources 3

3 Compare

- Compare your ledgers with a partner. Did you sort the same items into 'changed' vs. 'stayed the same'?
- Where did you disagree about whether something changed a lot, a little, or not at all?

4 Expand

Your teacher will add context, vocabulary, and information the sources leave out. Add it to your map.

5 Revise

Go back to your Event Map. Add, correct, or reorganize based on the discussion.

6 Conclude

Was the 19th Amendment a genuine turning point in American democracy, or a partial victory that left major exclusions in place? Use evidence from at least two sources — including at least one that addresses who could actually vote after 1920.